Name: _____ **Period:** _____ **Date:** _____

Topic 5.5 Guided Notes: Treatment of Psychological Disorders

Unit 5: Mental and Physical Health | AP Psychology

Directions: Read through the topic overview page below and fill in each blank as you go. Use the tables and activities to check your understanding, then head to the quiz link at the end to test yourself.

Source page: appsychreviewhub.com/overviews/topic5.5

Word Bank

Cultural Humility	*Integrity*	*Therapeutic Alliance*
Dream Interpretation	*Person-Centered Therapy*	*Deinstitutionalization*
Respect for People's Rights and Dignity	*Nonmaleficence*	*Free Association*
Evidence-Based Interventions	*Unconditional Positive Regard*	*Active Listening*
Fidelity		

Congratulations! You have reached the final topic in the AP Psychology curriculum. After spending the previous section exploring the diagnostic criteria for various psychological disorders, it is time to look at how we treat them. Treatment plans today often rely on an integrated approach, combining psychological talk therapies, behavioral conditioning, and biomedical interventions to give individuals the best possible outcomes.

1. Modern Trends and Ethical Foundations

Before diving into specific techniques, it is essential to understand the modern landscape of psychological treatment. Meta-analytic studies—research that combines data from many different studies—show consistently that psychotherapies are generally effective. Modern psychologists rely heavily on _____, which are treatments rigorously tested and supported by scientific research.

- The _____: For therapy to be successful, there must be a collaborative, trusting relationship between the therapist and the client. Building this relationship requires the therapist to practice _____: a continuous process of self-reflection, openness, and respect for the client's unique cultural background and lived experiences.
- _____: In the late 20th century, the discovery and widespread use of effective psychotropic medications led to a massive shift in mental health care. Hospitals and asylums discharged large numbers of patients, moving toward decentralized, community-based care. Today, therapists often prefer to treat individuals using a combination of medication and psychological therapies.

Ethical Principles: To help ensure we don’t return to the horrific mistakes of the past, the American Psychological Association (APA) establishes strict ethical guidelines for clinicians, including:

- _____: The obligation to avoid causing harm and to protect the well-being and safety of clients. A clinician following this principle would immediately discontinue a specific therapeutic intervention, such as an intense trauma processing technique, if it becomes clear that it is causing the client severe, destabilizing psychological distress rather than fostering therapeutic progress.

- _____: Keeping promises, building trust, and upholding professional responsibilities. This means that a therapist consistently arrives on time for sessions, honors all agreements made regarding the terms of treatment, and maintains reliable professional boundaries so the client can safely depend on the therapeutic relationship.
- _____: Promoting honesty, accuracy, and truthfulness in therapeutic practices. A clinician following this principle would provide completely transparent information about their professional credentials, utilize accurate billing codes for insurance claims, and avoid making misleading or exaggerated promises about the guaranteed outcomes of a treatment plan.
- _____: Honoring privacy, confidentiality, autonomy, and cultural differences. This means that a therapist actively involves the client in setting their own clinical goals—fully honoring their autonomy—while carefully adapting therapeutic approaches to respect and align with the client's unique cultural background and expectations of privacy.

Apply It: Which Modern Trend or Ethical Principle?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A clinic offers a new treatment for panic attacks only after controlled studies have shown that it works.	
2	Clients of one counselor say they feel like trusted partners working with her toward shared goals.	
3	A therapist asks a client from a different background to teach her about his traditions, regularly questions her own assumptions, and adapts her approach.	
4	A state closes most of its large psychiatric hospitals and funds neighborhood clinics and group homes instead.	
5	A school counselor realizes that a confrontational group exercise is humiliating a student, so she ends the activity to protect the student's safety.	
6	A therapist promises to return a client's call on Friday and does, keeps every agreed appointment time, and holds clear professional boundaries.	
7	A therapist honestly lists her training on her website, bills insurance only for sessions that happened, and tells a client that no treatment can guarantee a cure.	
8	A therapist keeps a teenager's records private, lets him choose which problems to work on first, and respects his family's cultural expectations about discussing emotions.	

2. Psychological Therapies

Psychological therapies (often called psychotherapy or “talk therapy”) involve interactions between a trained therapist and an individual seeking to overcome difficulties or achieve personal growth. Different psychological perspectives offer unique treatment techniques.

Psychodynamic Therapies

Rooted in Freud’s psychoanalytic tradition, these therapies focus on exploring unconscious thoughts, unresolved conflicts, and early childhood experiences. Therapists often use _____ (encouraging clients to

express thoughts without censorship) and _____ to bypass the conscious mind and uncover hidden psychological tensions.

Humanistic Therapies

Humanistic therapies emphasize human potential, self-awareness, and personal growth. The most prominent is Carl Rogers' _____, which relies on a few core techniques:

- _____: The therapist carefully listens, echoes, reflects, and clarifies what the client is saying to ensure they feel entirely heard and understood.
- _____: Providing complete, nonjudgmental acceptance and support, regardless of what the client says or does, fostering a safe space for true self-exploration.

Apply It: Psychodynamic and Humanistic Ideas

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A therapist asks a client to describe a recurring nightmare so that they can explore its hidden symbolic meaning.	
2	A counselor gives no advice or diagnoses; instead she offers empathy, warmth, and acceptance so that her client can find his own path toward growth.	
3	No matter what a client confesses about his past mistakes, the therapist responds with complete, nonjudgmental support.	

Word Bank

Biofeedback	*The Cognitive Triad*	*Cognitive-Behavioral Therapies (CBT)*
Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT)	*Maladaptive Thinking*	*Token Economies*
Cognitive Restructuring	*Cognitive Therapies*	*Applied Behavior Analysis*
Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)	*Aversion Therapies*	*Systematic Desensitization*
Hypnosis	*Exposure Therapies*	*Fear Hierarchy*
Group Therapy		

Behavioral Therapies (Applied Behavior Analysis)

Unlike psychodynamic or humanistic approaches, behavioral therapies do not focus on deep, underlying causes or the unconscious mind. Instead, they view disorders as learned behaviors that can be "unlearned" through the principles of classical and operant conditioning—a process known as _____.

- _____: Used heavily for anxiety and phobias, this involves gradually and safely exposing a person to their feared stimulus.
- _____: A specific type of exposure therapy where a client creates a _____ (a ranked list from least to most scary scenarios). The client is then taught relaxation

techniques and gradually exposed to the items on that list, pairing the feared object with a relaxed state rather than an anxious one.

- _____: This technique creates a negative association. It pairs an unwanted, harmful behavior (like drinking alcohol or biting nails) with an unpleasant stimulus (like a nausea-inducing drug or a foul taste) to reduce the behavior.
- _____: An operant conditioning technique often used in schools or inpatient facilities where individuals earn symbolic rewards for exhibiting desired, healthy behaviors. These rewards can later be exchanged for privileges or treats.
- _____: Using electronic monitoring devices, clients learn to gain voluntary control over physiological processes (like heart rate or muscle tension) to help regulate the autonomic nervous system and reduce feelings of anxiety.

Apply It: Which Behavioral Technique?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A therapist treats a child's tantrums as learned behaviors and uses conditioning principles to unlearn them, rather than digging into childhood memories.	
2	A woman afraid of elevators is gradually and safely taken from standing near an elevator door to riding in one.	
3	A man afraid of dogs learns deep relaxation and then works through photos, videos, and a calm puppy across the room, staying relaxed at each step.	
4	A client writes a ranked list of scary public-speaking situations, from chatting with one friend at the bottom to addressing the whole school at the top.	
5	A child who bites her nails has a bad-tasting polish painted on them so that the habit becomes unpleasant.	
6	A classroom awards points for finishing work and being kind, which students can trade for extra recess time.	
7	A man watches a monitor that shows his muscle tension and learns to relax his muscles so that the reading goes down.	

Cognitive & Cognitive-Behavioral Therapies

_____ assume that our thoughts directly influence our emotions and behaviors. The goal is to identify and change _____ (inaccurate, overly negative thoughts). Therapists use _____ to help clients challenge irrational beliefs and replace them with realistic ones.

- Proposed by Aaron Beck, _____ states that depression is fueled by a pattern of negative thoughts about oneself, the world, and the future. Cognitive therapy explicitly works to dismantle this pattern.

_____ are highly popular, evidence-based approaches that combine cognitive restructuring with behavioral modification. Notable examples include:

- _____: Developed by Albert Ellis, this aggressive therapy vigorously challenges a person's illogical, self-defeating attitudes and assumptions. For example, if a client insists they are a

complete failure after making a single mistake, the therapist will directly confront this absolute thinking by asking for logical evidence for why one minor error defines their entire personal worth.

- _____: Designed originally for Borderline Personality Disorder, it combines CBT techniques with mindfulness and acceptance strategies to help individuals regulate intense emotions and reduce self-destructive behaviors.

Apply It: Which Cognitive Concept?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A therapist starts from the idea that her client's thoughts, not the events themselves, are driving his low mood and anxiety.	
2	A student believes that any mistake proves he is incompetent and that everything will always go wrong; his thoughts are inaccurate and overly negative.	
3	A therapist helps a client test his belief that "nobody likes me" against real evidence and replace it with a more realistic thought.	
4	A depressed woman thinks, "I'm worthless, the world is unfair, and nothing will ever get better."	
5	A therapist teaches a client to challenge his anxious thoughts and also assigns step-by-step behavior experiments.	
6	A clinic treats a client with intense, unstable emotions by combining CBT skills with mindfulness and acceptance strategies.	

3. Group Therapy & Hypnosis

While most therapies can be conducted one-on-one, _____ offers unique advantages. By treating several clients at once, therapists allow individuals to share experiences, realize they are not alone, provide mutual support, and actively practice social skills in a safe environment.

Another specialized technique is _____, which involves a focused state of attention and heightened suggestibility. It is important to know the boundaries of this technique for the AP Exam: research shows it is effective for treating pain and managing anxiety, but it is not supported for retrieving accurate repressed memories or regressing individuals to an earlier age.

Apply It: Group Therapy or Hypnosis?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	Eight clients with social anxiety meet weekly with one therapist, share their experiences, and practice social skills together.	
2	A clinician guides a patient into a state of focused attention and heightened suggestibility to help the patient manage pain.	

📺 *Video Notes: "Getting Help: Psychotherapy" (Crash Course Psychology #35)*

Watch the video above, then answer each question below in your own words. The video follows a made-up client named Bernice. It also covers existential therapy, family therapy, and a few techniques that aren't on your page (like resistance and Socratic questioning), while your page covers ideas the video doesn't (like token economies, biofeedback, REBT, DBT, and hypnosis).

1. How does the video define psychotherapy, and what four major schools or orientations does it name?

2. How does the video describe psychoanalysis and psychodynamic therapy, and what criticisms does it mention?

3. How does the video describe existential-humanistic therapy and client-centered therapy?

4. What is the goal of behavior therapy, according to the video, and what methods does it name?

5. How does the video describe cognitive therapy, and how are the cognitive and behavior approaches combined?

6. What does the video say about group therapy and family therapy?

Word Bank

Antianxiety Drugs	*Antidepressants*	*Lithium*
Psychosurgery	*Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation (TMS)*	*Lobotomy*
Tardive Dyskinesia	*Lesioning*	*Electroconvulsive Therapy (ECT)*
Antipsychotic Medications		

4. Biomedical Interventions

Deriving from the biological perspective, these treatments address the physical, biochemical, or neurological roots of psychological disorders.

Psychotropic Medications

These drugs alter brain chemistry by interacting with specific neurotransmitters in the central nervous system:

- _____ (e.g., Xanax, Ativan): Depress central nervous system activity to calm individuals and reduce acute anxiety symptoms.
- _____ (e.g., Prozac, Zoloft): Often classified as SSRIs (Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitors), they increase the availability of neurotransmitters like serotonin and norepinephrine to elevate mood. (Need a review of reuptake inhibitors? See the Topic 1.3 page.)
- _____: A simple salt that acts as a highly effective mood-stabilizing medication, specifically used to treat the extreme manic highs and depressive lows of bipolar disorder.
- _____ (e.g., Thorazine, Haldol): Used to treat schizophrenia and other severe thought disorders. They primarily work by blocking dopamine receptors.
- Warning: Long-term use of older antipsychotics can lead to _____, a severe side effect characterized by involuntary, repetitive muscle movements, especially in the face, tongue, and limbs.

Brain Stimulation & Psychosurgery

When psychological therapies and medications fail to work, clinicians may turn to more invasive biomedical procedures:

- _____: A biomedical treatment for severe, treatment-resistant depression. It involves applying controlled electrical currents to the brain to trigger a brief, therapeutic seizure, which can rapidly relieve symptoms.
- _____: A newer, non-invasive alternative to ECT that uses magnetic pulses to stimulate specific, targeted areas of the brain to treat depression without inducing a seizure.
- _____: The most drastic and irreversible intervention, involving surgically altering or destroying brain tissue (_____). In the mid-20th century, the _____ (cutting the nerves connecting the frontal lobes to the inner brain) was used to calm violent patients, but thanks to modern medications, it is rarely, if ever, performed today.

Apply It: Which Biomedical Treatment?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A doctor prescribes a medication that depresses nervous system activity to calm a patient's sudden, acute anxiety.	
2	A patient with schizophrenia takes a medication that blocks dopamine receptors to reduce hallucinations and delusions.	
3	After years on an older antipsychotic, a man develops involuntary, repetitive movements of his tongue and face.	
4	A patient with severe depression who has not responded to other treatments receives a brief electrical current to the brain while anesthetized, producing a controlled seizure.	
5	In the mid-1900s, doctors cut the nerve connections between the frontal lobes and the rest of the brain to calm violent patients.	

📺 *Video Notes: "Biomedical Treatments" (Crash Course Psychology #36)*

Watch the video above, then answer each question below in your own words. The video also covers topics that aren't on your page (like how researchers test therapy, deep-brain stimulation, and lifestyle changes), while your page covers ideas the video doesn't (like tardive dyskinesia and the lobotomy).

1. How does the video say researchers judge whether psychotherapy works?

2. What is the difference between effectiveness and efficacy, and what does the video say about which therapies work best?

3. How does the video describe biomedical therapies, and what do antipsychotics and anxiolytics do?

4. How does the video describe antidepressants and mood stabilizers?

5. What are ECT, rTMS, and deep-brain stimulation, according to the video?

6. What does the video say about lifestyle changes and mental health?

Don't Trip Up! (Common Misconceptions)

⚠️ Systematic Desensitization vs. Aversion Therapy: Both are behavioral therapies based on classical conditioning, but their goals are opposites. _____ aims to remove a fear response (relaxing in the presence of a spider). _____ aim to create a negative response (feeling nauseous when tasting alcohol).

⚠️ The Truth About Hypnosis: If a question asks whether a therapist can use _____ to uncover a "lost" childhood memory to solve a trauma, the answer is no! It often creates false memories due to high suggestibility. It is only proven effective for pain management and relaxation.

⚠️ Schizophrenia vs. a Medication Side Effect: _____ is not a symptom of schizophrenia; it is a physical side effect of the medication used to treat schizophrenia (antipsychotics blocking dopamine). Read case studies carefully to see if the involuntary movements started before or after medication was prescribed!

Quick Check: Review Questions

Circle the best answer for each question below.

1. During an intense trauma-processing session, a therapist notices her client becoming severely destabilized and overwhelmed with distress rather than making therapeutic progress, so she immediately discontinues the technique to protect her client's well-being. This ethical principle, the obligation to avoid causing harm, is called:

- **A.** Fidelity
- **B.** Integrity
- **C.** Respect for People's Rights and Dignity
- **D.** Nonmaleficence

2. A psychodynamic therapist encourages his client to speak whatever comes to mind without any censorship or filtering, no matter how random, embarrassing, or seemingly unrelated the thoughts might seem, in order to uncover hidden unconscious conflicts. This technique is called:

- **A.** Free Association
- **B.** Cognitive Restructuring
- **C.** Systematic Desensitization
- **D.** Active Listening

3. During a therapy session, a humanistic therapist carefully listens to her client, echoes back what she has heard, and reflects and clarifies the client's statements to ensure the client feels completely heard and understood. This person-centered technique is called:

- **A.** Aversion Therapy
- **B.** Free Association
- **C.** Active Listening
- **D.** Cognitive Restructuring

4. To help a client stop drinking alcohol, a therapist gives him a medication that causes intense nausea every single time he consumes even a small amount of alcohol, creating a strong negative association with drinking. This behavioral technique, which pairs an unwanted behavior with an unpleasant stimulus, is called:

- **A.** Token Economy
- **B.** Biofeedback
- **C.** Aversion Therapy
- **D.** Systematic Desensitization

5. After a client insists that making one single mistake at work proves he is a "complete and utter failure" at everything, his therapist aggressively and directly challenges this irrational, absolute belief, demanding logical evidence for why one minor error should define his entire personal worth. This confrontational cognitive-behavioral approach, developed by Albert Ellis, is called:

- **A.** Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT)
- **B.** Systematic Desensitization
- **C.** Person-Centered Therapy
- **D.** Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)

6. A psychiatrist prescribes Prozac to a patient with severe depression, a medication classified as a Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitor that increases the availability of serotonin and norepinephrine in the brain to elevate mood. This class of psychotropic medication is called:

- **A.** Antianxiety Drugs
- **B.** Antidepressants
- **C.** Lithium
- **D.** Antipsychotic Medications

7. A patient with Bipolar Disorder is prescribed a simple salt-based medication specifically to stabilize her mood and prevent the extreme manic highs and depressive lows characteristic of her disorder. This mood-stabilizing medication is called:

- **A.** Antianxiety Drugs
- **B.** Antipsychotic Medications
- **C.** Antidepressants
- **D.** Lithium

8. As a newer, non-invasive alternative to more intensive brain treatments, a psychiatrist uses a device that delivers targeted electric pulses to a specific area of a depressed patient's brain, without inducing any seizure at all. This biomedical treatment is called:

- **A.** Electroconvulsive Therapy (ECT)
- **B.** Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation (TMS)
- **C.** Psychosurgery
- **D.** Lithium Treatment

9. Following the widespread introduction of effective psychotropic medications in the late 20th century, large numbers of patients were discharged from psychiatric hospitals and asylums in favor of decentralized, community-based mental health care. This significant historical shift is called:

- **A.** Evidence-Based Intervention
- **B.** The Therapeutic Alliance
- **C.** Deinstitutionalization
- **D.** Psychosurgery

✅ Check Your Progress

Done with your notes? Head over to the Quiz to test what you've learned:
https://appsychreviewhub.com/quiz

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